

The Letter of Peter to Philip

VIII 132,10-140,27

The Letter of Peter Which He Sent to Philip

“Peter the apostle of Jesus Christ, to Philip our beloved brother and our fellow apostle and (to) the brethren who are with you: greetings!

Now I want you to know, our brother [that] we received orders from our Lord and the Savior of the whole world that [we] should come [together] to give instruction and preach in the salvation which was promised us by our Lord Jesus Christ. But as for you, you were separate from us, and you did not desire us to come together and to know how we should organize ourselves in order that we might tell the good news. Therefore would it be agreeable to you, our brother, to come according to the orders of our God Jesus?”

When Philip had received these, and when he had read them, he went to Peter rejoicing with gladness. Then Peter gathered the others also. They went upon the mountain which is called “the (mount) olives,” the place where they used to gather with the blessed Christ when he was in the body.

Then, when the apostles had come together, and had thrown themselves upon their knees, they prayed thus saying, “Father, Father, Father of the light, who possesses the incorruptions, hear us just as [thou hast] [taken pleasure] in thy holy child Jesus Christ. For he became for us an illuminator in the darkness. Yea hear us.”

And they prayed again another time saying, “Son of life, Son of immortality who is in the light, Son, Christ of immortality, our Redeemer, give us power, for they seek to kill us.”

Then a great light appeared so that the mountain shone from the sight of him who had appeared. And a voice called out to them saying, “Listen to my words that I may speak to you. Why are you asking me? I am Jesus Christ who am with you forever.”

Then the apostles answered and said, “Lord, we would like to know the deficiency of the aeons and their pleroma.” And: “How are we detained in this dwelling place?” Further: “How did we come to this place?” And: “In what manner shall we depart?” Again: “How do we have [the] authority of boldness?” [And]: “Why do the powers fight against us?”

Then a voice came to them out of the light saying, “It is you yourselves who are witnesses that I spoke all these things to you. But because of your unbelief I shall speak again. First of all concerning [the deficiency] of the aeons, this [is] the deficiency, when the disobedience and the foolishness of the mother appeared without the commandment of the majesty of the Father. She wanted to raise up aeons. And when she spoke, the Arrogant One followed. And when she left behind a part, the Arrogant One laid hold of it, and it became a deficiency. This is the deficiency of the aeons. Now when the Arrogant One had taken a part, he sowed it. And he placed powers over it and authorities. And [he] enclosed it in the aeons which are dead. And all the powers of the world rejoiced that they had been begotten. But they do not know the pre-existent [Father], since they are strangers to him. But this is the one to whom they gave power and whom they served by praising him. But he, the Arrogant One, became proud on account of the praise of the powers. He became an envier and he

wanted to make an image in the place [of an image] and a form in the place of a form. And he commissioned the powers within his authority to mold mortal bodies. And they came to be from a misrepresentation, from the semblance which had emerged.

Next concerning the pleroma: I am the one who was sent down in the body because of the seed which had fallen away. And I came down into their mortal mold. But they did not recognize me; they were thinking of me that I was a mortal man. And I spoke with him who belongs to me, and he harkened to me just as you too harkened today. And I gave him authority in order that he might enter into the inheritance of his fatherhood. And I took 137 [...] they were filled [...] in his salvation. And since he was a deficiency, for this reason he became a pleroma.

It is because of this that you are being detained, because you belong to me. When you strip off from yourselves what is corrupted, then you will become illuminators in the midst of mortal men. And this (is the reason) that you will fight against the powers, because [they] do not have rest like you, since they do not wish that you be saved.”

Then the apostles worshipped again saying, “Lord, tell us: In what way shall we fight against the archons, since [the] archons are above us?”

Then [a] voice called out to them from the appearance saying, “Now you will fight against them in this way, for the archons are fighting against the inner man. And you are to fight against them in this way: Come together and teach in the world the salvation with a promise. And you, gird yourselves with the power of my Father, and let your prayer be known. And he, the Father, will help you as he has helped you by sending me. Be not afraid, [I am with you forever,] as I previously [said to] you when I was in the body.”

Then there came lighting and thunder from heaven, and what appeared to them in that place was taken up to heaven.

Then the apostles gave thanks to the Lord with every blessing. And they returned to Jerusalem. And while coming up they spoke with each other on the road concerning the light which had come. And a remark was made concerning the Lord. It was said, “If he, our Lord, suffered, then how much (must) we (suffer)?”

Peter answered saying, “He suffered on [our] behalf, and it is necessary for us too to suffer because of our smallness.”

Then a voice came to them saying, “I have told you many times: It is necessary for you to suffer. It is necessary that they bring you to synagogues and governors, so that you will suffer. But he who does not suffer and does not 139 [...] [...] the] Father [...] in order that he may [...].”

And the apostles rejoiced [greatly] and came up to Jerusalem. And they came up to the temple and gave instruction in salvation in the name of [the] Lord Jesus Christ. And they healed [a] multitude.

And Peter opened his mouth, he said to his (fellow) disciples, “[Did] our Lord Jesus, when he was in the body, show us everything? For he came down. My brothers, listen to my voice.” And he was filled with a holy spirit. He spoke thus: “Our illuminator, Jesus, [came] down and was crucified. And he bore a crown of thorns. And he put on a purple garment. And he was [crucified] on a tree and he was buried in a tomb. And he rose from the dead. My brothers, Jesus is a stranger to this suffering. But we are the ones who have suffered through the transgression of the mother. And be-

cause of this, he did everything like us. For the Lord Jesus, the Son of the immeasurable glory of the Father, he is the author of our life. My brothers, let us therefore not obey these lawless ones and walk in 140 [... Then] Peter [gathered together the others also] saying, ["O, Lord Jesus] Christ, author [of our] rest, give us a spirit of understanding in order that we also may perform wonders."

Then Peter and the other apostles saw [him] and they were filled with a holy spirit. And each one performed healings. And they parted in order to preach the Lord Jesus; and they came together and greeted each other saying, "Amen."

Then Jesus appeared saying to them, "Peace to you [all] and everyone who believes in my name. And when you depart, joy be to you and grace and power. And be not afraid; behold, I am with you forever."

Then the apostles parted from each other into four words in order to preach. And they went by a power of Jesus, in peace.